



EMPLOYEE BENEFITS HANDBOOK

RANK AND FILE – HEAD OFFICE BASED

Overview

Equicom Savings Bank employs more than a hundred permanent employees and it continuously strives to offer a competitive benefits package designed to support the health, financial well-being and work-life balance of employees. The purpose of this handbook is to provide a comprehensive and easy way to understand overview of the benefits the bank offers to its eligible employees. By putting this information in one place, we hope for an easy resource for employees who have questions on what benefits are available. This handbook will be updated periodically to reflect changes to the compensation and/or benefits offered by the bank.

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COMPENSATION AND BENEFITS PACKAGE FOR HEAD OFFICE BASED RANK AND FILE EMPLOYEES

Upon regularization, the following are the entitlement for the annual benefits, subject to existing laws and guidelines on the grant of each benefit

VACATION LEAVE

Policies and Implementing Guidelines

1. All regular employees are entitled to 15 working days' vacation leave with pay per year or 1.25 days per month, reckoned from the date of regularization. On the third year of employment, an employee may be given an additional one (1) day vacation leave benefit and he/she shall be granted one day leave entitlement every year of tenure but up to a maximum of 20 days VL only. As a matter of practice, for employees who are on regular status as of the first working day of January, the 15 days' Vacation Leave for the whole year is credited in advance in January of each year. For employees who will be regularized during the year, the leave benefit shall accrue to them on a monthly basis as the 1.25 days VL/month are earned.
2. Employees are required to take a yearly **Mandatory Leave** for five (5) consecutive working days, which is part of the leave entitlement for the year. In the beginning of the year the immediate superior or the Division Head shall discuss and fix the schedule with his/her team to ensure efficiency on the day-to-day operations of the business unit. It is the responsibility of the Division Head to monitor compliance of all employees within his/her unit. When availing for mandatory leave, employees shall be specific when filing in the ESS so that HRD can properly identify availment of mandatory leave from regular vacation leave.
3. Vacation leave must be filed at least two (2) days prior to leave of absence. For prolonged vacation leave, the employee is required to submit his leave application one (1) week prior to intended date of leave.
4. Vacation leave due to emergency reasons must be filed within three (3) working days upon reporting back to work.
5. A non-working holiday declared during an employees' vacation leave shall not be counted as part of the leave. This does not mean however that the leave may be extended by another day. The employee should request approval for the extension.

6. Employees who go on leave without prior approval from their superiors, or who extend their leave without prior approval of the extension, or who refuse to be recalled from their leave without any valid reason, shall be considered absent without official leave (AWOL) and without pay.
7. In case the vacation leave benefit for the year is not availed by year-end:
 - a. a maximum of five (5) days per year will be converted to its money equivalent and credited to the employees' payroll account in January of the following year;
 - b. a maximum of five (5) days per year will be carried over to the following year for future use or will be accumulated (banked)
 - c. the remaining days, if any, will be forfeited

Bankable Vacation Leave Credits

A maximum of 30 days (equivalent to six year's bankable credits) may be accumulated. Any leave credits in excess of 30 days will be converted to its money equivalent. Thus, after an employee has banked 30 days VL, he can convert to its money value a maximum ten (10) days' Vacation leave per year.

In case an employee resigns, retires or is separated from the service for any reasons, the money equivalent (computed at the current monthly regular salary) of the employee's earned vacation leave credits up to a maximum of thirty (30) days shall be paid to him. However, if the employee has used up all his/her vacation leave credits intended for the whole year (which is credited in advance at the beginning of the year), he shall reimburse to the bank the money equivalent of the leave credits used but not yet earned as of the date of separation.

SICK LEAVE

1. All regular employees are entitled to a 15-working days' sick leave with pay reckoned from the date of regularization or 1.25 days per month. On the third year of employment, an employee may be given an additional one (1) day sick leave benefit and he/she shall be granted one day leave entitlement every year of tenure but up to a maximum of 20 days sick leave only.
2. If an employee cannot report for work due to illness, he/she must notify his/her immediate manager through telephone.
3. Sick leave must be filed within three (3) working days upon reporting back for work.

4. A Medical Certificate is required for sick leave lasting for at least three (3) days.
5. If public and/or official holidays occur while the employee is on sick leave, the said leave is not counted.
6. Failure to notify the immediate superior about the absence within the first two (2) working hours shall warrant a denial of sick leave benefit and absence shall be treated as without office leave (AWOL) and without pay.
7. Unused sick leave will be accumulated to a maximum of thirty (30) days.
8. Sick leaves in excess of thirty (30) days shall be converted to cash and credited to the employee every January 15 payroll.
9. In case of resignation or retirement, the cash equivalent of the employee's accumulated sick leave credits shall be paid to him. The money value shall be based on his current salary.
10. In case an employee is terminated, he will not be paid for any accrued sick leaves.

EMERGENCY LEAVE

1. All regular employees may avail of an emergency leave for a maximum of 3-working days per year.
2. Emergency leave shall be allowed under the following circumstances:
 - a) Employee is a victim of flood, storm, earthquake, or other grave natural calamity
 - b) For parents – spouse or child is hospitalized
 - c) An immediate member of family dies. For purposes of this leave, the following are considered as immediate members of the family:
 - For single employees - parents, children, if any (whether biological or adopted), siblings
 - For married employees – spouse, children, parents, parents-in-law

Since the employee is entitled to two days Bereavement Leave, only the leave in excess of two days shall be filed as an emergency leave. (Note: There's a separate transaction account for Bereavement Leave in the Employees Self-Service System (ESS))

3. Emergency leave must be filed within three (3) working days upon reporting back for work
4. Supporting documents (i.e. hospitalization documents or death certificate, as the case may be) must be submitted to the employee's immediate superior.

HALF-DAY LEAVE

1. Subject to approval of his superior, an employee may avail of Half-day leave:

Half Day Leave	Work Schedule				
	7:00-4:00	7:30-4:30	8:00-5:00	8:30-5:30	9:00-6:00
Morning	12:00-4:00	12:30-4:30	1:00-5:00	1:30-5:30	2:00-6:00
Afternoon	7:00 – 11:00	7:30-11:30	8:00-12:00	8:30-12:30	9:00-1:00

2. An employee who is late and/or on undertime on the half-day that he reports for works shall be considered to be on one (1) whole day leave. (In other words, an employee on half-day leave must strictly observe and complete the four hours of work schedule mentioned in Number 1 above).

BEREAVEMENT LEAVE

As a gesture of concern and support for an employee during his time of grief due to the demise of an immediate family member, the Bank shall allow him to go on bereavement leave with pay for two-days , subject to guidelines provided herein.

Implementing Guidelines

1. The Bereavement Leave of 2 working days with pay shall not be chargeable to the employee's vacation leave credits.
2. Immediate family for purpose of the bereavement leave shall include the following:
 - Single employees: Parents, siblings, children (if any, whether biological or legally adopted)
 - Married employees: Spouse, children, parents, parents-in-law
3. An employee who avails of the bereavement leave should notify his immediate superior of his absence by phone or any means of communication. Upon reporting back for work, he should file his leave in the Employee Service System (ESS) and have this approved by the appropriate authorities as provided in the ESS.
4. For record purpose, the employee should submit to Human Resources Division (HRD) a hard copy of the application for bereavement leave, together with the death certificate of the family member, within one month from date of availment.

EMPLOYEE UNIFORM

A newly regularized Rank and File employee is provided with a new set of uniforms for free. Each employee receives 4 sets every year which is required to be worn Monday to Thursday. Employees who are unable to wear the prescribed office uniform must notify the HRD in writing of the reason(s). An employee has the option to have extra uniform, charged to the employee

MID-YEAR BONUS

The grant of a mid-year bonus is not mandated under the law, but given solely at the discretion of the Bank.

Implementing Guidelines:

The Bank grants to all employees on regular status as of May 15 of the current year a mid-year bonus, subject to the guidelines provided herein.

1. The amount of Mid-year bonus is equivalent to one-half month Basic Salary for regular employees with at least one year tenure as of May 15 of the current year or pro-rated amount for those with less than one-year tenure. (For this purpose, tenure shall be reckoned from the date of hiring or the date the employee reported for work).
2. The mid-year bonus shall be paid in May through credit to employees payroll accounts.
3. The mid-year bonus shall be withheld from an employee who has a pending administrative case. It will be released after resolution of his case, provided the decision is not termination. Otherwise, the mid-year bonus is forfeited.
4. Payment of the mid-year bonus shall be withheld from an employee who is under suspension. It will be released after the employee has reported back for work.
5. The mid-year bonus of an employee who incurs leave without pay or suspended for at least one month (in successive day) during the year shall be pro-rated as follows:

$$\text{Mid-year bonus} = \frac{1}{2} \text{ Monthly Basic Salary} \times \frac{\text{Number of Months}}{12 \text{ months}}$$

RICE ALLOWANCE

The Company grants all regular employees a rice subsidy amounting to P2,000 every month.

MEDICINE ALLOWANCE

The grant of a medicine Allowance is not mandated under the law but given solely at the discretion of the Bank

Implementing Guidelines

Coverage: The Bank grants to all employees on regular status as of January 1 of the current year a medicine allowance subject to the guidelines provided herein:

1. The amount of Medicine Allowance is P3,000 for the Rank and File employees who are on a regular status as of January 1, of the current year.
2. The Medicine Allowance shall be paid in January through credit to employees' payroll accounts.
3. The Medicine Allowance of employees who will be regularized after January 1 will be paid in December of the same year. The amount shall be pro-rated based on tenure, which is reckoned from the date of their regularization.
4. In compliance with BIR Ruling No. 019-2002 dated May 9, 2002, the Medicine Allowance shall be substantiated with Official Receipts in the employee's name on or before the annualization of withholding taxes in any given year. Accordingly, employees who receive the Medicine Allowance shall submit the Official Receipts covering their medicine purchases on or before the third week of November of the year.
5. In case the total/partial amount of Medicine Allowance is not substantiated with medicine receipts, the said amount shall be subject to withholding tax.

OVERTIME / PREMIUM PAY AND NIGHT DIFFERENTIAL

Overtime/Premium Pay

The Bank shall grant overtime/premium pay to employees who are authorized to render overtime work after official working hours (during working days) or to work during non-working days, or holidays, in order to perform tasks necessary for the bank's productivity, efficiency and continuous operation.

Eligibility: Only Rank and File are entitled to overtime/premium pay whenever they are required or authorized to render overtime work/work during rest days/non-working holidays.

When overtime work/work during rest days or non-working holidays may be authorized or required:

Supervising Officers may require or authorize/approve overtime work for any of the following reasons, subject to limitations and approvals:

1. To meet deadlines, provided that work to be done is over and above the employee's assigned responsibilities.
2. To attend the voluminous transactions that cannot be accommodated during the regular work shift.
3. To attend to branches' transactions during non-working holidays.

Implementing Guidelines

1. Requests for overtime work should be properly filed and approved in the Employee Self Service (ESS), before rendering actual overtime work.
2. Employees who were absent the day prior to rendering overtime shall not be authorized to render overtime with pay, unless their services are needed for operational efficiency of the department/branch.
3. The number of overtime hours to be rendered should be specified in the overtime request filed in the Employee Self Service System. Actual work should not exceed time stipulated and approved. Should a necessity come up which would warrant the extension of the approved number of hours, the employee should request for authorization or approval of the additional or extension hours. Otherwise, without any further approval, payment of work rendered shall be based on the originally approved number of hours.
4. No overtime work of less than one (1) hour shall be authorized.
5. In the computation of overtime pay, the start of overtime work rendered after regular working days shall be reckoned at 6:00pm. This is to enable the employee to take his/her meal break for thirty (30) minutes for health reasons.
6. No work shall be authorized on Sundays unless work on the same subject was rendered by the same employee for at least eight (8) hours on the previous day/Saturday and the work is necessary to complete and accomplish the pending work. However, this condition may be disregarded provided that the reason for not rendering work on Saturday is specifically justified by the Division Head.
7. Payment of overtime work shall be effected through payroll in the following month, provided that the overtime is filed and approved in the Employee Self Service (ESS) on the specified deadline.

Approving Authorities:

Prior authorization from the Division/Branch Head should be secured before rendering overtime work with pay.

SAVING CLAUSE: Management reserves the right to amend or modify the provisions of this policy as it deems fit or as necessitated by social and labor legislations.

Night Shift Differential

The Bank shall pay a Night Differential equivalent to 10% of regularly hour rate to employees whose duty falls at nighttime (between 10:00 pm to 6:00 am) The 10% Night Differential is also added to the OT rates for overtime work during the said hours.

HEALTHCARE AND INSURANCE COVERAGE

A. Healthcare and Healthcare Maintenance Services and Programs

The grant of a comprehensive healthcare and health maintenance services is not mandated under the law but given solely at the discretion of the Bank to complement the statutory health and welfare benefits provided under the SSS/ECC and Philhealth.

1. Coverage: The Bank provides to all employees on regular status a comprehensive healthcare and health maintenance services coverage, subject to the guidelines provided herein.

Implementing Guidelines

1. All regular employees shall be entitled to the healthcare and maintenance coverage with a reputable HMO (currently the provider is Maxicare) upon hiring. Employees on probationary status shall be provided with the said coverage upon their regularization.
2. The amount of coverage for Rank and File is P75,000.00
3. The coverage of an employee who resigns/retires or is separated from the service for any reason shall be cancelled upon the effectivity of his resignation.
(Details of the benefits, services and programs are contained in the contract between the Bank and the HMO provider concerned.

HMO COVERAGE OF DEPENDENTS

The Company shall give its regular employees the option to enroll their qualified legal dependents in the Group Hospitalization program but subject to salary deduction. However, the Company agrees to subsidize dependent's HMO premium, but up to 2 dependents only, provided that the following conditions shall be observed:

1. The premium will be shared between the Company and the employee at 30%-70% basis, of which, 30% of the premium shall be subsidized by the Company.
2. The number of dependents that will be qualified for enrollment shall be based on the tenure of the employee:
 - 3 years to 5 years 1 dependent
 - More than 5 years 2 dependents
3. Below are the qualified dependents recognized for HMO enrollment:
 - for married employees: his/her spouse below the age of 60 years old and legitimate children who are unmarried, financially dependent on the employee and not over 21 years old.
 - for single employees, the parents who are below the age of 65 years old.
4. The share of the employee on the insurance premium shall be deducted from his/her monthly salary. An authorization to deduct shall be submitted to HRD for payroll processing.

Termination of Coverage

The dependent's HMO coverage shall be discontinued according to the following conditions:

1. The employee resigns or is separated from the company
2. The dependent reaches the age limit or becomes ineligible
3. The employee voluntarily removes the dependent from the plan

GROUP TERM LIFE INSURANCE

The grant of a Group Term Life Insurance is not mandated under the law, but given solely at the discretion of the Bank to complement the statutory welfare benefits provided under the SSS/ECC and Philhealth.

Coverage

The Bank provides to all employees on regular status a Group Term Life insurance coverage subject to the guidelines provided herein.

Implementing Guidelines

1. All employees on regular status shall be entitled to the Group Term Life Insurance coverage upon hiring. Employees on probationary status shall be provided with the said coverage upon regularization.
2. The amount of coverage (which is currently provided by Maxilife) is based on rank, as follows:

Rank and File	P500,000
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3. The coverage of an employee who resigns/retires or is separated from the service for any reason shall be cancelled upon the effectivity of his resignation.
(Details of the benefits are contained in the contract between the Bank and the Life Insurance provider)

RETIREMENT AND GRATUITY

Gratuity Pay

This benefit shall be granted to a resigning employee who has completed at least 5 years service, regardless of age, provided that:

- 1) He/she is not the subject of an audit examination or under investigation where he/she is the primary liable employee in a case involving fraud/theft or gross negligence which resulted in losses to the bank; and
- 2) His/her resignation is in order, i.e., complies with the 30-day notice requirement, unless this requirement is expressly waived by Management.

The amount of Gratuity Pay shall be equivalent to: Years of service Amount (to be based on FMBP*)

5 years up to less than 10 75% of FMBP for every year of service
10 years up to less than 15 100% of FMBP for every year of service
15 years up to less than 20 125% of FMBP for every year of service
20 years up to less than 25 150% of FMBP for every year of service
25 years up to less than 30 175% of FMBP for every year of service
30 years 200% of FMBP for every year of service

*FMBP refers to Final Monthly Basic Salary

Retirement Benefit

This benefit shall be granted to a retiring employee who is at least 60 years old with at least five years service, pursuant to Article 287 of the Labor Code. The amount of retirement benefits shall be equivalent to 75% of Final Monthly Basic Pay for every year of service, a fraction of at least six months being considered as one year. For tenure of 10 years and up, the retirement benefits shall be based on the table above.

MULTI-PURPOSE LOAN

The Multi-purpose loan for EQB Employees is extended to regular employees to assist them in meeting their medical, household and other personal needs.

Terms and Conditions

1. Maximum Loanable Amount, subject to the credit ratio limits described in the item 5		
Rank and File	With at least 6 months up to 1 year tenure	One month Basic Salary (Payable in 6 months)
	With more than 1 year tenure	Two (2) Months Basic Salary
2. Interest Rate	10% per annum	
3. Term of Loan	6,12,18 or maximum of 24 months (payable through monthly payroll deduction) In case of dismissal, separation, retirement or resignation, the loan becomes due and demandable.	
4. Re-availment of Loan	Re-availment prior to loan maturity may be allowed provided that 1) at least 75% of existing loan has been paid; and 2) the remaining amortization shall be deducted from the proceeds of the new loan	
5. Credit Ratio	Monthly amortization on loans, statutory conditions and other liabilities regularly deducted from the salary such as, but not limited to, SSS Loan, Withholding Tax, Pag-ibig loan and Philhealth, etc. must not exceed 40% of the gross monthly compensation (i.e., take-home pay should at least be 60% of employees' gross pay)	
6. Other Conditions	a. Employee's rating should be at least "Meets Standards" b. An Employee with a pending Administrative Case or who is serving a sanction may only be eligible to avail of a loan in the following instances: • If the final decision on the employee's case is exoneration • Six (6) months after serving the sanction of a written reprimand for Class "A" and Class "B" offense • One (1) year after serving the sanction of suspension.	
7. Approving Authority		
• Endorsement	Immediate Supervising Officer and Division / Branch Head	

● Processing, Endorsement, Certification and Recommendation	Human Resource Division
● Approval	President / OIC or his/her designated Officer
8. Processing and Releasing	1. Duly accomplished Employee Loan Application form together with the following: Post-dated check, Promissory Note and Disclosure shall be submitted to HRD. If married, a photocopy of two (2) valid IDs of spouse should also be submitted.
	2. HRD shall be responsible in monitoring the routing of employee's application to ensure timely approval and releases.
	3. A key condition for approval of a multi-purpose loan amounting to P500,000.00 is the submission and approval of an acceptable guarantor.
	4. Upon completion of approval, HR Admin shall submit all documents to Loans Operations Department for the loan release.
	5. Loan releases shall be on the first (1 st) day and 16 th of the month. If these dates fall on a weekend or holiday , release shall be on the next banking day. Deviations from this schedule may be allowed in emergency cases or for valid reasons, subject to the approval of the Operations Division Head.
	6. HR Admin shall compute the credit ratio for rank and file and the FASD Head for officers after the employee has submitted the duly accomplished documentary requirements.

LEAVE BENEFITS MANDATED BY LAW

MATERNITY LEAVE

Pursuant to Republic Act (RA) Bo 11210, also known as the Expanded Maternity Leave Law (EMLL).

In relation to Section 14-A on Maternity Leave Benefit RA, 11199, also known as the Social Security Act of 2018, the Bank shall grant maternity benefits in accordance with the implementing rules and regulations as provided herein.

These rules and regulations shall be known as the implementing Rules and Regulations of the 105-day Expanded Maternity Leave Law”.

MATERNITY BENEFITS

All covered female employees regardless of civil status or the legitimacy of the child shall be granted the following maternity benefits:

1. One Hundred Five (105) days for live childbirth, regardless if via normal delivery or caesarian section.
2. Additional fifteen (15) days paid leave if the female worker qualifies as a solo parent under the applicable provisions of RA 8972;
3. Sixty (60) days paid leave of miscarriage and emergency termination of pregnancy;

The daily maternity benefit is equivalent to one hundred (100%) of the female’s daily salary credit. Employed female members shall receive full pay which consists of their (i) SSS maternity benefit computed based on their average daily salary credit and (ii) salary differential to be paid by the Bank, if any.

Eligibility

To qualify for the grant of maternity leave benefit, the female employee must meet the following requirements:

1. She must have paid at least three (3) monthly contributions in the twelve-month period immediately preceding the semester of childbirth, miscarriage or emergency termination on pregnancy. She must have notified her employer of her pregnancy and the expected date of her childbirth, which notice shall be transmitted to the SSS.
2. The expecting woman employee has rendered service to the employer at least six (6) months (or aggregate of) for the last twelve (12) months
3. The childbirth delivery is of the first four deliveries.

Implementing Guidelines

These guidelines shall be observed for child delivery, miscarriage and emergency termination of pregnancy occurring on or after March 11, 2019 as per SSS Circular No. 2019-009.

1. Maternity Leave benefit shall be granted to a qualified female member/employee in every instance of pregnancy, miscarriage, or emergency termination of pregnancy regardless of frequency.
2. The maternity leave benefits granted shall be enjoyed by a female member even if she has a pending administrative case.
3. Employers from the private sector shall pay for the difference between the full salary and the actual cash benefits received from the SSS.
4. Covered female employees availing of the maternity leave benefits must receive their full pay and shall be advanced by the Bank within thirty (30) days from the filing of maternity leave application.
5. SSS shall immediately reimburse the Bank of one hundred (100%) of the account of maternity benefits advanced by the Bank to the employee upon receipt of pertinent and medical documents.
6. Enjoyment of Maternity Leave cannot be deferred but should be availed on before or after the actual period of delivery in a continuous or uninterrupted manner.
7. A female employee entitled to maternity leave benefits may, at her option, allocate up to seven days of said benefits to the child's father, whether or not the same is married to the female employee. The allocated benefit granted to the child's father under the Expanded Maternity Leave Law is over and above that which provided under RA 8187, or the "Paternity Leave Act of 1996"
8. An additional maternity leave of thirty (30) days, without pay, can be availed of, at the option of the female employee, provided that the Bank shall be given due notice in writing, at least 45 days before the end of maternity leave.
9. A claim for maternity leave benefit must be filed with the SSS with ten (10) years from the date of delivery, miscarriage or emergency termination of pregnancy. (late filing)

PATERNITY LEAVE

The guidelines on the grant of Paternity Leave benefit are compliant with the provisions of Republic ACT No 8187

The paternity leave benefit is granted to a married male employee to allow his seven (7) days of time with pay to attend to his wife's childbirth or miscarriage, and help care for the newborn child while his wife is still recuperating subject to the following process:

1. The employee is cohabiting with his legitimate spouse at the time she gives birth or suffers a miscarriage.
2. The childbirth or delivery is unexpected, the employee should inform his immediate superior and the HRD within two (2) working days from the date of birth or delivery through telephone. The leave must be properly filed for in the ESS within three (3) working days upon returning to work.
3. Within five (5) working days upon returning to work, employee must submit to HRD a photocopy of the following:
 - Birth Certificate
 - Medical Certificate

SPECIAL LEAVE BENEFIT FOR WOMEN

The benefit shall be granted pursuant to Section 21 (B) of the implementing rules and regulations of Republic Act No. 9710 (otherwise known as the Magna Carta of Women) and in accordance with the guidelines issued by the Department of Labor and Employment.

Guidelines:

1. A female employee regardless of age and civil status shall be entitled to two (2) months leave with pay based on her gross monthly compensation following surgery caused by gynecological disorders, provided that she has rendered continuous aggregate employment service of at least six (6) months for the last twelve (12) months prior to surgery.

For this purpose, gynecological disorders refer to disorders that would require surgical procedures such as, but not limited to, dilatation and curettage and those involving female reproductive organs such as the vagina, cervix, uterus, fallopian tubes, ovaries, breasts, adnexa and pelvic floor, as certified by a competent physician.

2. To avail of this special leave benefit, the employee concerned shall file her application for leave within five (5) days from the expected date of surgery. Application for special leave prior to the scheduled surgical procedure must be properly filed electronically in the Employee Self-Service (ESS). However, prior application for leave shall not be necessary in cases requiring emergency surgical procedure, provided that the employee's supervising officer shall be notified verbally or in writing within three (3) days after surgery and provided further that after the surgery or appropriate recuperating period, the employee shall immediately file her leave application manually, by submitting a duly accomplished leave form to Human Resources Department (HRD).

3. Upon her return to work, the employee shall submit to HRD a medical certificate issued by the hospital where the surgery was performed.

4. The special benefits leave for women contemplated herein, which is in addition to leave privileges under existing laws, is non-cumulative and non-convertible to cash.

PARENTAL (SOLO PARENT) LEAVE

This benefit shall be granted pursuant to Section 8 Republic Act No. 8972 (solo parents welfare act). The solo parent leave of not more than seven (7) working days every year shall be granted to any solo parent employee who has rendered at least one year in the service, subject to the guidelines provided herein.

1. The employee has rendered at least one-year service whether continuous or broken.
2. The employee has notified the Bank of the availment of the leave within a reasonable time period.
3. The employee has presented a Solo Parent Identification Card issued by the Department of Social Welfare and Development (DSWD)
4. The employee is a solo parent as defined under RA 8972, i.e., any individual who falls under any of the following categories:
 - A woman who gives birth as a result of rape or crimes against chastity, even without final conviction of the offender, provided that the mother keeps and raises the child.
 - Parent left solo or alone with the responsibility of parenthood due to death of spouse
 - Parent left solo or along with the responsibility of parenthood while spouse is detained or service sentence for a criminal conviction for at least one year.
 - Parent left solo or alone with the responsibility of parenthood due to physical and/or mental incapacity or spouse as certified by a public medical practitioner.
 - Parent left solo or alone with the responsibility of parenthood due to legal separation or de facto separation from spouse for at least one (1) year; provided that he/she is entrusted with the custody of the children.
 - Parent left solo or alone with the responsibility of parenthood due to declaration of nullity or annulment of marriage as decreed by a court or by a church; provided that he/she is entrusted with the custody of the children.
 - Parent left solo or alone with the responsibility of parenthood due to abandonment of spouse for at least one year.
 - Unmarried mother/father who has preferred to keep and rear her/his children instead of having others care for them or given them up to a welfare or institution.

- Any other person who solely provides parental care and support to a child/children provided he/she is duly licensed as a foster parent by the DSWD or approved legal guardian by the court.
 - Any family member who assumes the responsibility of head of family as a result of the death, abandonment, disappearance or absence lasts for at least one (1) year.
5. The child / children referred in No. 4 above refer to those living with and dependent upon the solo parent for support who are unmarried, unemployed and below eighteen (1) years and above but are incapable of self-support because of mental and/or physical defect/disability.
 6. A change in the status or circumstance of the parent claiming benefits under the Act, such that she/he is no longer left alone with the responsibility of parenthood shall terminate his/her eligibility for these benefits.
 7. The Solo Parent Leave is non-cumulative and non-convertible to cash, if not availed of.

BATTERED WOMAN LEAVE

This benefit shall be granted pursuant to R.A. No. 9262 (Anti-Violence Against Women and their Children Act) and in accordance with the guidelines issued by the Department of Labor and Employment.

Guidelines:

1. This leave with pay of up to ten (10) days may be availed of by an employee who is a victim of violence, which may be physical, sexual or psychological and who applies for the issuance of a protection order that will shield her from further violence and provider her related reliefs.
2. The application of leave should be accompanied by a certification from the Barangay office or clerk or court that an action under RA 9262 has been filed and is pending.
3. The leave shall be used to attend to medical and legal concerns relative to her situation.
4. The leave is non-cumulative and non-convertible to cash if not availed of.

ACKNOWLEDGMENT FORM

By signing this document, I acknowledge that I have received a copy of the Employee Benefits Manual. I understand that this manual contains information regarding the benefits, perks, and policies currently offered by Equicom Savings Bank.

I understand that it is my responsibility to read and familiarize myself with the contents of the manual.

I understand that if I have questions regarding any information in the manual, I should contact the Human Resources Department for clarification.

I understand that this manual supersedes all prior benefit summaries, handbooks, or verbal representations regarding company benefits.

Received by:

Date Received:

Name of Employee
